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LECTURE (1)

Introduction

- Communication is the basic element of human interactions that allows people to establish, maintain and improve contacts with others.
- Effective interpersonal communication skills between health care providers and client/patients are one of the most significant factors for improving client/patients' satisfaction, compliance and overall health outcome
- It is essential that nurses develop and maintain an understanding of the methods and skills of communication in order to meet the needs of the client/patient.



- Nurses have an important role in the care of client/patients in a variety of healthcare settings. Therefore, every point of contact can be an opportunity to improve client/patient care and relationships using effective communication.
- The quality of care provided is dependent on the quality of communication that exists between the nurses and their client/patients.



- When nurses communicate effectively with interest, listen actively and demonstrate compassion, client/patients may be more likely to report their experiences as positive, even at times of distress and ill health
- The clients who understand details of their illness and treatment, whom perceive and believe the provider is concerned about their well-being, often show greater satisfaction with the care received and are more likely to follow with treatment regimes.

2. Definition of Communication

- The word communication originates from ‘communis’, a Greek word, meaning ‘to make common’. Communication is “a process by which people exchange ideas, facts, feelings or impressions in ways that each gains a ‘common understanding’ of meaning, intent and use of a message.



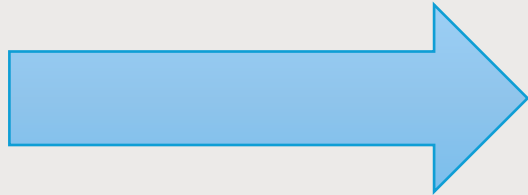


- In general, communication refers to the reciprocal exchange of information, ideas, facts, opinions, beliefs, feelings & attitudes through verbal or nonverbal means between people
- It includes listening and understanding with respect, as well as expressing views and ideas and passing information to others in a clear manner
- Communication is an art, and like any art it is a learning skill influenced by the presence of special talent in some persons





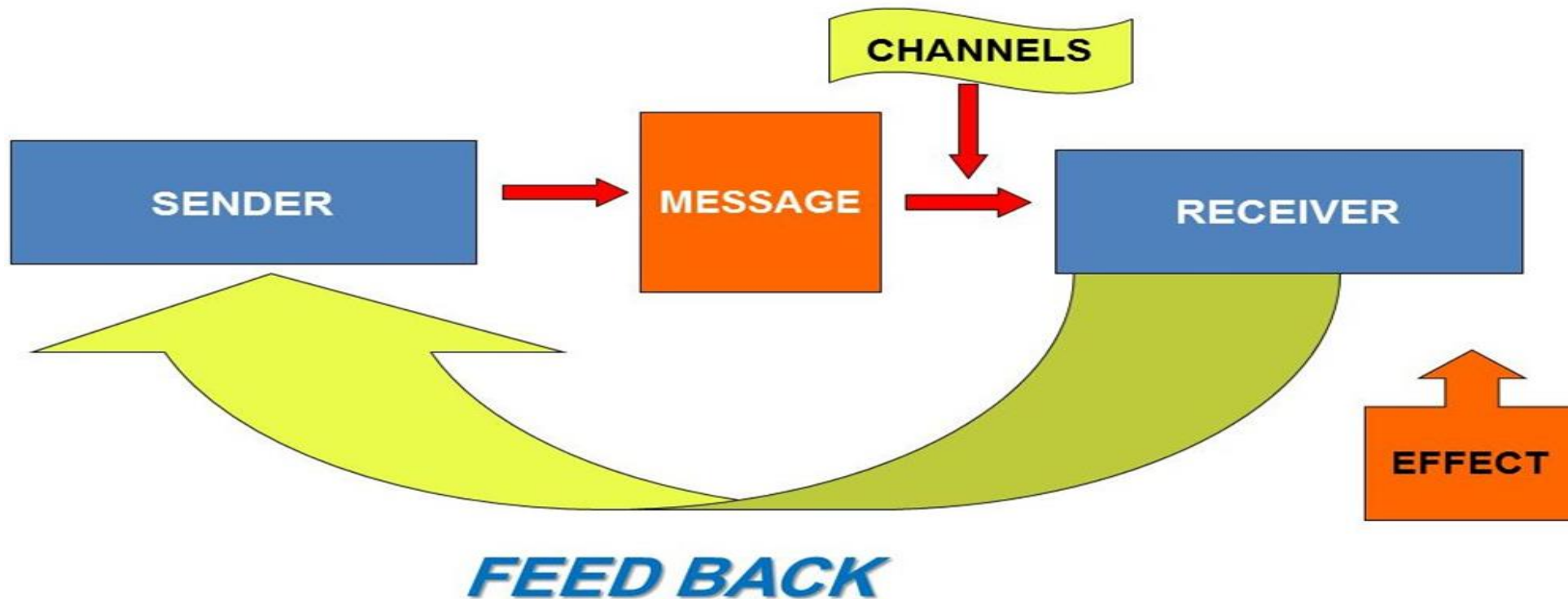
Why communication is important?



- **Effective communication is the basis of mutual understanding & trust.**
- **Gets your point across.**
- **Informs and Educates.**
- **Helps in rapport building**
- **Helps in Co-operation in treatment and rehabilitation.**
- **Stimulates new ideas**
- **On the other hand Poor communication causes a lot of misunderstanding, hinders work & productivity.**

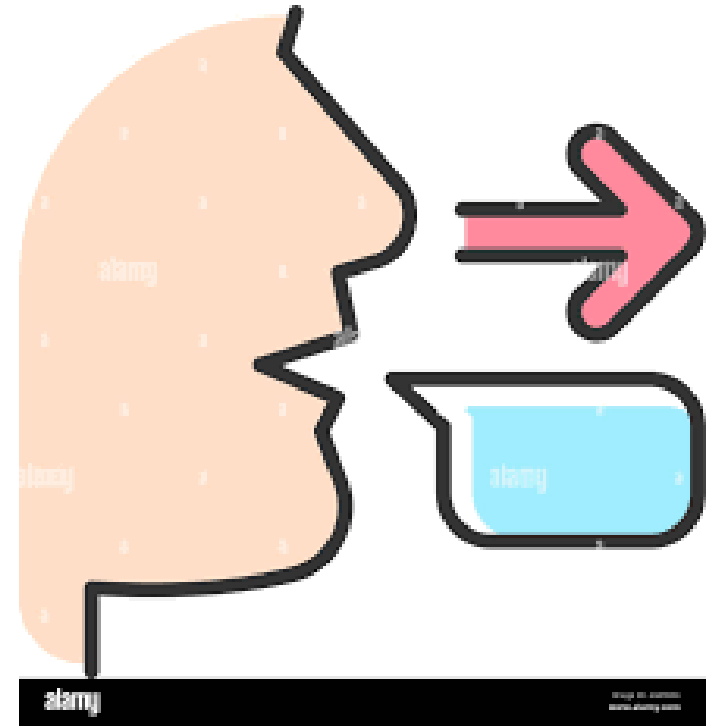
Elements of Communication

The Six Elements of Communication



1- Sender

- A sender is a person who encodes & sends the message to the expected receiver through an appropriate channel.
- The impact of the message will depend on sender's communication skill, social status (authority), knowledge, attitude and prestige in the community.



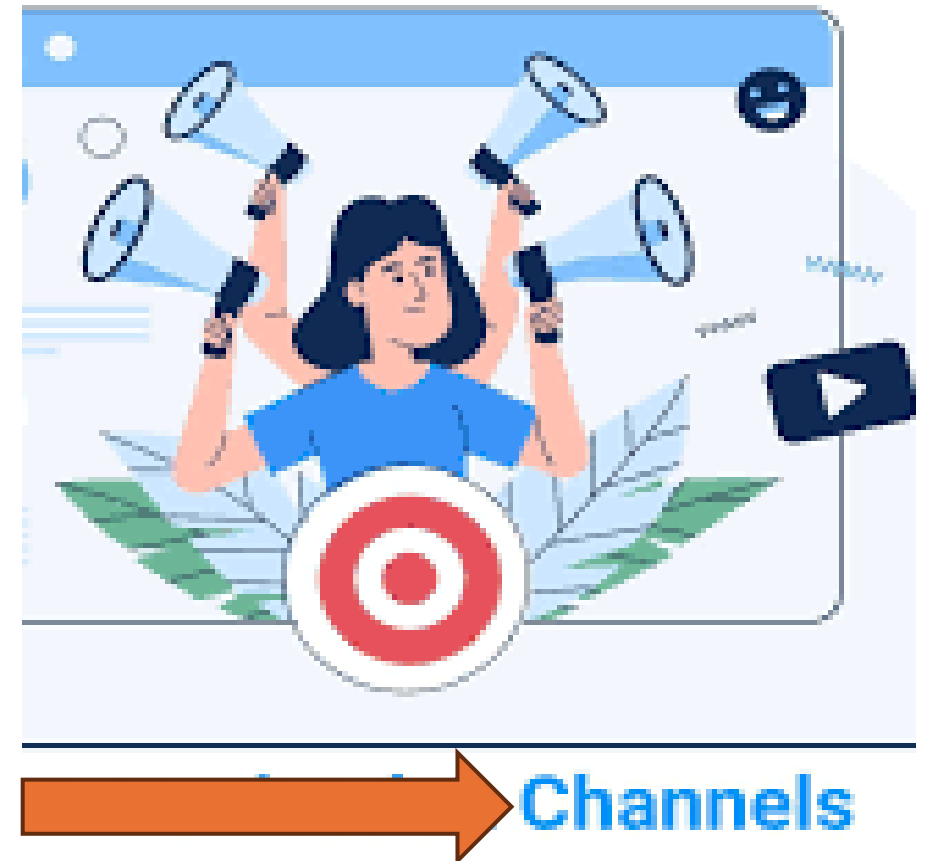
2-Message

- The message is the content of communication & may contain verbal or nonverbal language.
- Perception & personal factors of the sender and receiver may sometimes distort this element so the intended outcome of communication may not be achieved.
- For example, the same message may be communicated or perceived differently by two individuals.



3-Channel

- A channel is a medium through which a message is sent or received between two or more people.
- Several channels can be used to send or receive the message, i.e. seeing, hearing, touching, and smelling, writing & feeling.
- While selecting channels of communication, several factors must be considered: availability of channels, purpose, suitability, types of receivers, types of message, preference of sender & receivers, communication skills of the sender, cost, etc.

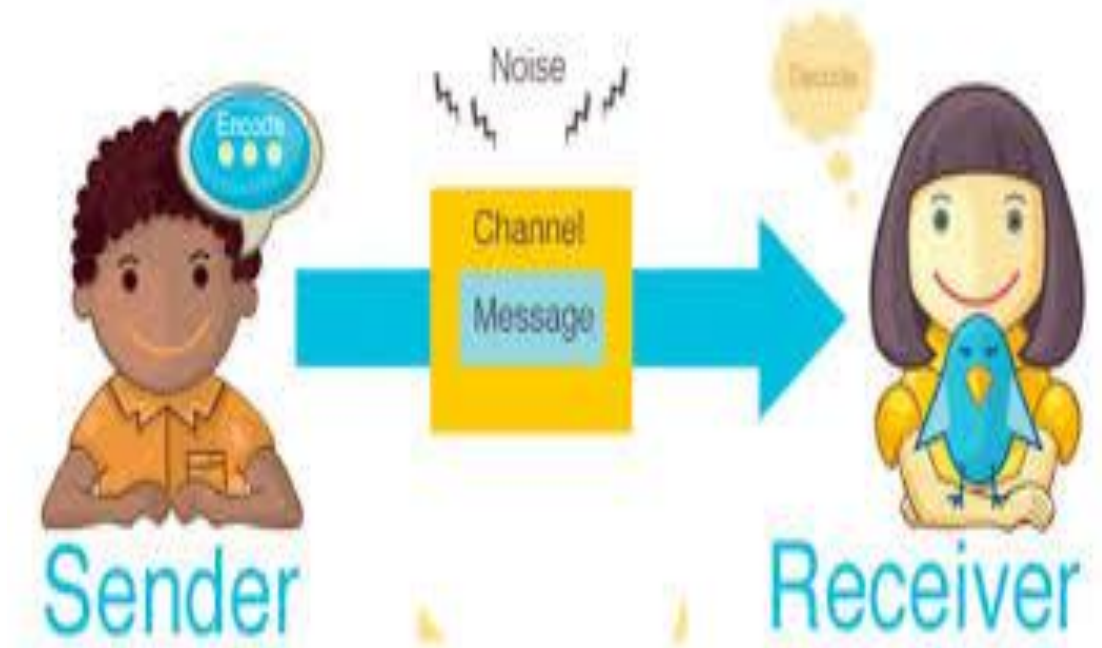


Classification of channels of communication:

- **Visual channel:** Facial expression, body language, posture, gestures, pictures & written words, electronic mails, mass media, etc.
- **Auditory channel:** Spoken words, sounds, telephone or mobile communications, delivering audio content (radio, voicemail), etc.
- **Tactile channel:** Touch sensations, therapeutic touch, etc.
- **Combined channel:** Audiovisual media, consoling a person with touch & spoken words.
- Every channel of communication has its advantages and limitations.
- The proper selection and use of channels results in successful communication

4- Receiver

- A receiver is an individual or a group of individuals intended to receive, decode & interpret the message sent by the sender/source of message and give feedback.
- He is expected to have the ability & skills to receive, decode & interpret the message
- A receiver also known as decoder.
- Communication has only taken place if the message being sent was accurately received

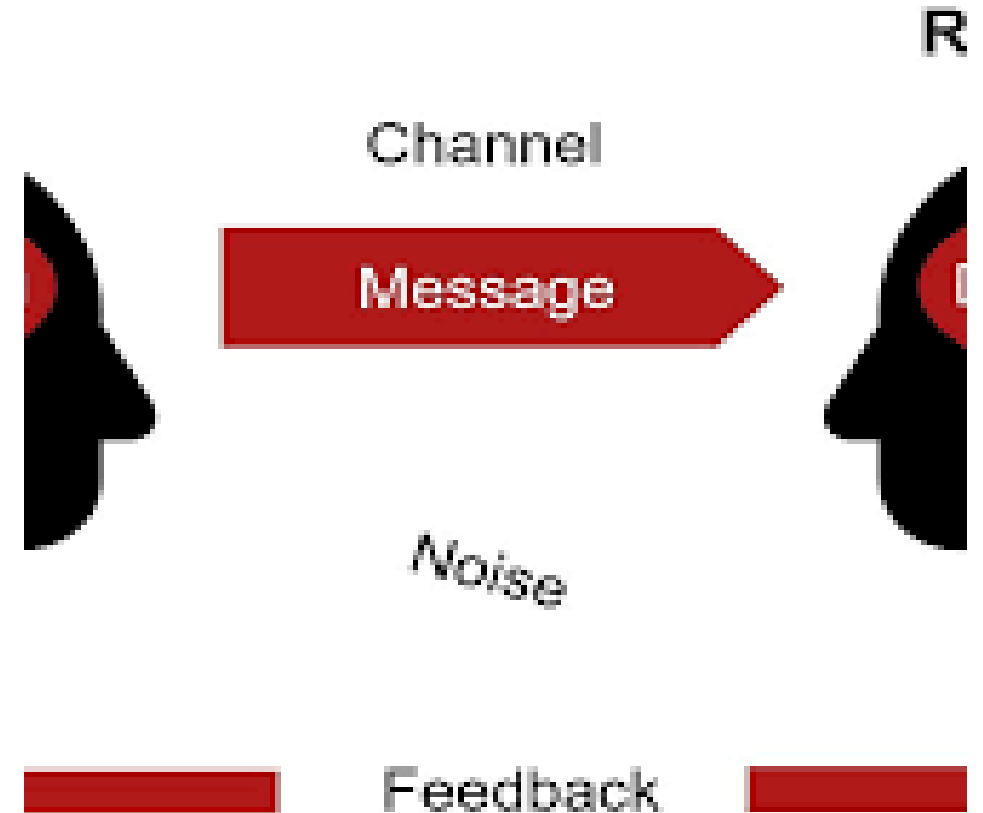


5-Feedback:

- ✓ It is a return message sent by the receiver to the sender.
- ✓ It is most essential element of the communication process as it shows that the receiver has understood the primary message sent by the sender.
- ✓ A successful communication must be a two-way process where the sender sends the message & receives feedback from the receiver.

The feedback could be positive or negative

- **Positive feedback:** the receiver accepted the concept of the message.
- **Negative feedback:** the receiver resisted the concept of the message.



6-Effect

The effect of communication is the end results of the communication process which could be emotional, cognitive or physical.



